

Amendment No. 1 to HB2592

Crawford
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 2102*

House Bill No. 2592

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 7, is amended by adding the following as a new chapter:

7-70-101.

As used in this chapter:

(1) "Electric utility":

(A) Means a utility that provides electric utility services to the public and is owned by a municipality that provides electric service to the public authorized under title 7, chapter 52, or another law, including, but not limited to, a city charter or private act;

(B) Includes an electric utility that provides electric utility services outside of this state; and

(C) Does not include an energy or utility authority created pursuant to the Municipal Energy Authority Act, compiled in title 7, chapter 36, or a private act of the general assembly;

(2) "Home county" means the primary county in which the home municipality is located, if the home municipality is an incorporated city or town;

(3) "Home municipality" means the municipality that owns an electric utility;

(4) "Incorporated city or town" does not include a metropolitan government;

(5) "Municipality" means a county, a county having a metropolitan form of government in this state, or an incorporated city or town;

(6) "Outside county":

(A) Means the county in which an outside locality is located; and

(B) Does not include the home county;

(7) "Outside locality" means a municipality that:

(A) Receives electric utility services from an electric utility; and

(B) Is located outside of the municipal boundaries of the home municipality; and

(8) "Utility board" or "board":

(A) Means the governing body of an electric utility; and

(B) Does not include the governing body of the home municipality.

7-70-102.

(a) Notwithstanding another law to the contrary, and except as provided by § 7-70-107:

(1) If an electric utility provides services in the home county to not less than three thousand five hundred (3,500) customers and not more than one hundred thirty thousand (130,000) customers, then the home municipality must expand the utility board to include one (1) additional voting board member on the utility board for the home county, if the home county chooses to appoint a person pursuant to § 7-70-103; and

(2) If an electric utility provides services to more than one hundred thirty thousand (130,000) customers in the home county, then the home municipality must expand the utility board to include two (2) additional voting board members on the utility board for the home county, if the home county chooses to appoint such persons pursuant to § 7-70-103.

(b) Notwithstanding another law to the contrary, and except as provided by § 7-70-107, if an electric utility provides services to not less than three thousand five hundred (3,500) customers in an outside locality, then the home municipality must expand the utility board to include one (1) additional voting board member on the utility board for the outside county in which such outside locality is situated, if the outside county chooses to appoint a person pursuant to § 7-70-103. This subsection (b):

(1) Only allows one (1) additional board member per outside county, regardless of the number of outside localities located within the outside county; and

(2) Does not permit the expansion of a utility board to include a board member from a municipality in another state.

7-70-103.

(a) If a home county or outside county that is entitled to appoint a board member pursuant to § 7-70-102 chooses to appoint a person, then the chief executive officer of the home county or outside county for which an additional board position is added pursuant to § 7-70-102 shall appoint a person to fill the new position, subject to approval by a majority vote of the governing legislative body of the applicable home county or outside county.

(b) The chief executive officer shall:

(1) Appoint a person who is a resident of the home county or outside county, as applicable, and a customer of the electric utility; and

(2) Not appoint a person who is an employee or board member of the electric utility or another utility.

7-70-104.

(a) If a utility board is expanded pursuant to this chapter, then the home municipality may:

(1) In consultation with the appointing chief executive officer, establish initial, staggered appointments of two (2) years to ensure consistent and experienced representation, followed by terms of four (4) years that begin on January 1 and end on December 31 of each applicable year; provided, that the first of such terms must be deemed to begin on January 1, 2027, or the January 1 following an electric utility's expansion of service into an outside locality; or

(2) In consultation and agreement with the appointing chief executive officer, establish term lengths, term limits, and term start dates that are similar to, and coincide with, the term lengths, term limits, and term start dates of board members appointed by the home municipality; provided, that the board member begins serving on January 1, 2027.

(b) A board member appointed pursuant to this chapter may be reappointed for successive terms.

(c) A board member appointed pursuant to this chapter serves until their successor is selected and assumes office. In the event of a vacancy, the chief executive officer of the appointing county shall appoint a person in accordance with § 7-70-103 to fill the vacancy for the remainder of the unexpired term.

(d) A board member appointed pursuant to this section is subject to the same removal process used for other board members of the utility board; provided, that the chief executive officer who appointed the board member must be given written notice no less than ten (10) business days before removal proceedings occur.

7-70-105.

A board member appointed pursuant to this chapter is not an employee of the home municipality and is not entitled to compensation for service as a board member. However, this section does not prohibit or otherwise limit a utility board or other appropriate entity from choosing to provide compensation to a board member appointed pursuant to this chapter.

7-70-106.

Notwithstanding § 7-70-102, a home municipality shall not expand board membership for a home county, outside county, or outside locality if the home county, outside county, or outside locality is represented by a voting member on the board. This section does not exempt an electric utility or home municipality from the requirements of § 7-70-102 for another home county, outside county, or outside locality for which a voting board member position does not exist.

7-70-107.

(a) Except for new board positions required by § 7-70-102 or subsection (c), this chapter does not authorize an electric utility to create additional board positions in excess of the membership limits imposed by another state law or private act.

(b) This chapter does not require a home county or outside county to appoint a person to a board member position or otherwise utilize the board member position to which the home county or outside county is entitled under § 7-70-102.

(c)

(1) If the application of this chapter results in a majority of the positions of a utility board not being appointed by the home municipality, then the home municipality may increase the membership limits of that utility board to such minimum number of board positions that ensures the home municipality holds the appointment authority for a simple majority of the positions on the utility board.

(2) The home municipality shall fill such additional board positions in the manner established for regular utility board members.

7-70-108.

(a) If a home county or outside locality reaches the customer thresholds described in § 7-70-102, then the electric utility shall notify, no later than November 1 following the date such threshold is reached, the home municipality and the chief executive officer that would be entitled to appoint a board member.

(b) The chief executive officer that would be entitled to appoint a board member must appoint a board member by the following January 1.

7-70-109.

(a) Except as provided in subsection (c), if an electric utility is governed by a utility board on May 1, 2026, then the utility must continue to be governed by a utility board.

(b) Except as provided in subsection (c), the governance of an electric utility described in this section must not be changed from a utility board to the governing body of the municipality on or after May 1, 2026.

(c) An electric utility may become an energy or utility authority pursuant to the Municipal Energy Authority Act, compiled in title 7, chapter 36, or a private act of the general assembly, as long as its utility board includes board members appointed consistent with this chapter.

7-70-110.

This chapter does not apply to an electric utility operated by the governing body of a home municipality, or to an energy or utility authority created pursuant to the Municipal Energy Authority Act, compiled in title 7, chapter 36.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it.